



validates identity. Ironically, Kashi has never played a senior official game in its home city of Varanasi.

"When we started, the infrastructure needed to run an elite club was not available in Uttar Pradesh. We played one game in Lucknow at the Ekana Stadium, but the federation said the ground was not at the (required) level, which is

why we had to go and play in Kalyani (West Bengal)," Prithijit said.

The club is building a football-specific stadium in the Bhelupur locality of Varanasi, which will serve as its home venue.

"We have a full academy set-up in Kashi and our own ground for youth matches. We hope that soon we will be able to play our first-team

matches at home as well."

Inter Kashi, much like Varanasi, has learned to be steady like the Ganges and patient like the ghats. But only time will tell whether the cheers that echoed through Mahabalipuram on that February morning will one day be heard back home — helping the beautiful game blossom in a non-footballing state.